Alternatively, you can edit the .csproj file directly and add a `<ProjectReference>` element inside an `<ItemGroup>` element with the relative path to the referenced project's .csproj file:

```
<ItemGroup>
  <ProjectReference
    Include="..\..\src\ExchangeRates.Web\ExchangeRates.Web.csproj" />
</ItemGroup>
```

Note that the path is the *relative* path. A `".."` in the path means the parent folder, so the relative path shown correctly traverses the directory structure for the solution, including both the src and test folders shown in Solution Explorer in figure 35.5.

TIP Remember that you can edit the .csproj file directly in Visual Studio by double-clicking the project in Solution Explorer.

Common conventions for project layout

The layout and naming of projects within a solution are completely up to you, but ASP.NET Core projects have generally settled on a couple of conventions that differ slightly from the Visual Studio File > New defaults. These conventions are used by the ASP.NET team on GitHub, as well as by many other open-source C# projects.

The following figure shows an example of these layout conventions. In summary, these are as follows:

- The .sln solution file is in the root directory.
- The main projects are placed in a src subdirectory.
- The test projects are placed in a test or tests subdirectory.
- Each main project has a test project equivalent, named the same as the associated main project with a .Test or .Tests suffix.
- Other folders (such as samples, tools, and docs) contain sample projects, tools for building the project, or documentation.